

Singapore Banks

2Q25 preview: Weaker 2Q as NIM declines, focus on guidance updates

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Singapore banks will be announcing their 2Q25 financials starting with OCBC on Aug 1st, followed by DBS and UOB both on Aug 7th. For 2Q, we expect earnings to decline from 1Q25 at -6% qoq, mainly due to a: **1) Sharp decline in NIMs in 2Q of -10 to -12bps qoq**, reflecting the recent sharp fall in SORA and HIBOR despite steady Fed fund rate; **2) Lower qoq fee income** mainly due to weaker investment sentiment in April though recovering in May and June; **3) Lower other non-interest income** impacted by market conditions and as OCBC's insurance profit normalizes. These headwinds are expected to be partially offset by: **4) well-controlled opex; 5) qoq lower credit cost**, albeit at the higher end of the banks' guidance range, reflecting our conservative stance.

Given the expectation of sharper decline in interest rates and heightened macro uncertainties, we believe the primary focus of the upcoming earnings season will be on potential revisions to guidance updates. Notably, UOB currently has no official guidance for 2025. Another key area of interest will be the achievability of mid-to-long term ROE targets of 15-17% for DBS, and 14% for both UOB and OCBC. Currently, we only forecast DBS to achieve its target by 2027.

Decomposing NIM sensitivity by currency

In 2Q25, spot SORA declined 72bps and 1M HIBOR declined 300bps despite a steady Fed Funds rate on the back of an influx of liquidity. To account for the movement in SORA and HIBOR, and resultant impact to banks' NIMs, we decomposed the NIM sensitivity analysis of Singapore banks by currency, breaking down Singapore banks' balance sheets by currency and using banks' guidance on fixed/floating assets and repricing assumptions to derive NIM sensitivity for each currency. The analysis also incorporates accounting asymmetries from deploying excess US\$ liquidity into other currencies via swaps, and the anticipated roll-off of cash flow hedges. Overall, we lower our NIM forecasts for Singapore banks by 8-14bps from 2Q25E to 4Q27E, with a sharp decline of 10-12bps expected in 2Q25 and a further decrease of 5-6bps in 3Q25, also incorporating our economists' updated outlook of five Fed rate cuts between 3Q25E and 2Q26E from three

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previously.

Remain positive on Singapore banks; Buy DBS, UOB, OCBC

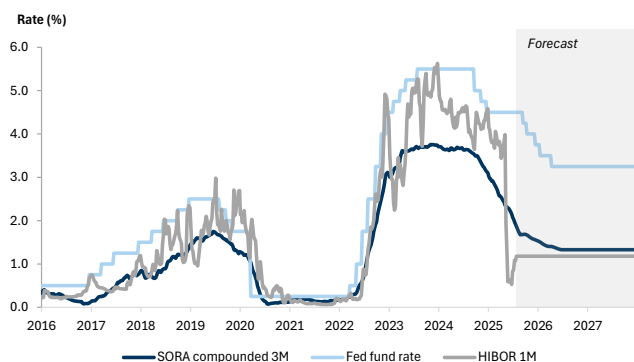
Despite a 7% increase in the past month and a 4% YTD gain, Singapore banks' share prices are still underperforming the STI, which is up 8% and 10% respectively. This relative underperformance occurs amid investor expectations of accelerated and increasing Fed rate cuts and uncertainties in the macro environment and a recent preference for mid cap stocks within the STI in anticipation of MAS's S\$5bn initiative to support the stock market. However, we maintain a favorable outlook on Singapore banks, supported by the strength of the Singapore dollar, their robust and sustainable profitability, and decent capital returns. As such, we remain Buy on all three Singapore banks.

NIMs to be under pressure amid sharp declines in SORA and HIBOR

In 2Q25, spot SORA declined 72bps and 1M HIBOR declined 300bps despite a steady Fed Funds rate on the back of an influx of liquidity as well as a weakening USD for SORA. This will likely put pressure on banks' NIMs. To account for the movement in SORA and HIBOR, and the resultant impact to banks' NIMs, we decomposed the NIM sensitivity analysis of Singapore banks by currency. We (1) break down the balance sheets of the three banks by currency, based on both group and subsidiary reporting; (2) Using previous banks' guidance on the mix of fixed and floating assets per currency and repricing assumptions of each asset/liability classes with bank disclosures and guidance on overall group NIM sensitivity, we derive the NIM sensitivity for each currency; (3) Incorporating the current interest rate movements and our economists' new assumptions for changes in benchmark rates of different currencies into the NIM sensitivity analysis to derive our new NIM forecasts.

Beyond the benchmark rate analysis by currency, our NIM forecasts also incorporate the effects of: 1) accounting asymmetries, which arise as DBS and UOB deploy excess US\$ liquidity into other currencies through swaps; 2) the anticipated roll-off of cash flow hedges at DBS and OCBC, commencing in 2Q26 (more details of hedging analysis [here](#)).

All in, we revise down our 2Q25E to 4Q27E NIMs forecasts by 8-14bps for Singapore banks. We anticipate a sharp decline of 10-12bps in 2Q25E, followed by a further decrease of 5-6bps in 3Q25E, driven by the recent sharp falls in HIBOR and SORA despite a steady Fed Funds rate. Our revised forecasts also incorporate our economists' updated outlook of five Fed rate cuts between 3Q25 and 2Q26, compared to the previous assumption of three.

Exhibit 1: HIBOR and SORA fell significantly in 2025 despite a steady Fed fund rate**Exhibit 2: We break down the NIM sensitivity by currency to bake in higher pass-through of rate decline in SORA and HIBOR**

Theoretical NIM sensitivity	DBS	UOB	OCBC
Floating rate loans (%)	67%	70%	67%
S\$	55%	62%	60%
US\$	75%	75%	78%
HK\$	70%	75%	70%
Others	75%	76%	66%
CASA (%)	53%	56%	49%
S\$	83%	67%	75%
US\$	34%	39%	26%
HK\$	48%	50%	38%
Others	32%	53%	46%
NIM impact (bps)	-2.2	-4.7	-4.4
25bps SORA	-1.1	-1.6	-1.8
25bps FED	0.2	-0.2	0.0
25bps HIBOR	-0.7	-1.2	-0.2
25bps other currency	-0.5	-1.8	-2.4
EPS impact (%)	-1.3	-3.3	-2.6
ROE impact (bps)	-21	-45	-31

Loan mix			
S\$	38%	43%	37%
US\$	25%	18%	21%
HK\$	10%	7%	11%
Others	26%	32%	31%

NIM sensitivity guidance:

DBS - Nil S\$4mn per 1bps Fed cut

UOB - 1.2bps per 25bps Fed cut

OCBC - Nil S\$5mn per 1bps cut in 4 major currencies

Source: Thomson Reuters Eikon, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: We expect Singapore banks to see 10-12bps qoq decline in NIM in 2025E

NIM (%)	2023	2024	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25E	3Q25E	4Q25E	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E
DBS	2.15	2.13	2.15	2.12	2.00	1.95	1.94	1.93	1.92	1.90	1.88	1.86	1.87	1.87	1.87
UOB	2.09	2.03	2.00	2.00	1.90	1.85	1.84	1.83	1.84	1.84	1.84	1.84	1.85	1.85	1.85
OCBC	2.28	2.20	2.15	2.04	1.92	1.86	1.85	1.84	1.84	1.82	1.81	1.80	1.81	1.81	1.81
QoQ (%)					2Q25E	3Q25E	4Q25E	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E
DBS					-0.12	-0.05	-0.01	-0.01	-0.01	-0.02	-0.02	-0.02	0.01	0.00	0.00
UOB					-0.10	-0.05	-0.01	-0.01	0.00	0.00	0.01	0.00	0.01	0.00	0.00
OCBC					-0.12	-0.06	-0.01	-0.01	-0.01	-0.01	-0.01	-0.01	0.01	0.00	0.00
Change vs. old GSe (%)					2Q25E	3Q25E	4Q25E	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E
DBS					-0.09	-0.13	-0.11	-0.10	-0.09	-0.09	-0.10	-0.11	-0.11	-0.11	-0.10
UOB					-0.09	-0.13	-0.12	-0.11	-0.09	-0.09	-0.08	-0.08	-0.08	-0.08	-0.08
OCBC					-0.08	-0.14	-0.13	-0.12	-0.10	-0.10	-0.10	-0.11	-0.11	-0.11	-0.11

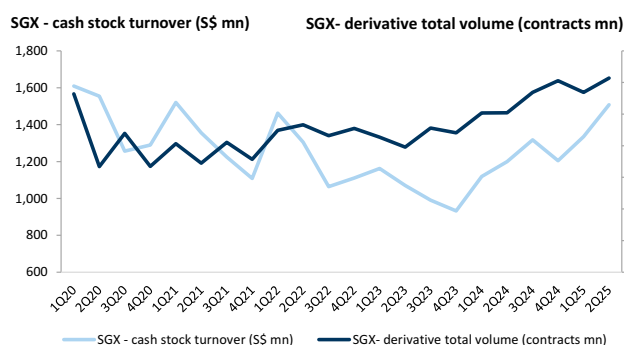
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Fee income to provide some cushion, especially from wealth management

We see fee income providing a cushion against declining NIMs, especially for the Singapore banks with 44% of their fees being market-related fees as of 2024, which tend to benefit during periods of hyper market activity level. Wealth management fees

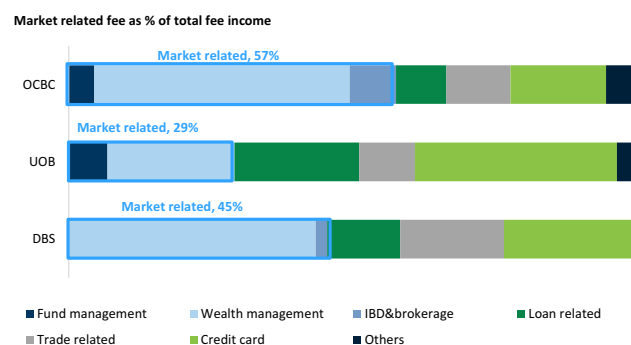
are the largest contributor, accounting for 36% of total fee income in 2024, and remain a key area of focus for these banks. Despite initial disruptions in investment sentiment following Liberation Day, banks have noted a recovery in May and June, with a continued robust trend. This recovery is further evidenced by elevated activity levels in both the Singapore Exchange and Hong Kong Exchange. In addition to wealth management, banks are seeing other major fee income items, such as credit card and loan-related fees, sustain a stable pace. Consequently, we forecast +9% yoy growth in non-NII for 2Q25, albeit tapering by -5% qoq.

Exhibit 4: The Singapore Exchange sustained a high activity level



Source: Singapore Exchange

Exhibit 5: Wealth management fees are key contributors to SG banks' fee income



Source: Company data

2Q25 Preview: Weaker 2Q as NIM declines

Singapore banks will be reporting their 2Q25 financials starting with OCBC on Aug 1st, followed by DBS and UOB both on Aug 7th. For 2Q, we expect earnings decline by -6% qoq, though ROE will be still decent at 13.7% on average mainly due to a: **1) Sharp decline in NIMs in 2Q of -10 to -12bps qoq**, reflecting recent sharp falls in SORA and HIBOR despite a steady Fed funds rate; **2) Lower qoq fee income** mainly due to disruptions to investment sentiment post the Liberation Day, despite a recovery later in the quarter; **3) Lower other non-interest income** as investment gains are expected to be impacted by market conditions and as OCBC's insurance profit normalizes. These headwinds are expected to be partially offset by: **4) well-controlled opex**; **5) qoq lower credit cost**, albeit remaining at the higher end of the banks' guidance range, reflecting our conservative stance. We expect OCBC to see the largest qoq core net income decline of -7% qoq with UOB the smallest at -4% qoq.

- **DBS:** We forecast 2Q25 net profit of S\$2,727mn (-6% qoq/-1% yoy), with ROE still decent at 16.4%. On a qoq basis, the decline in bottom line was primarily driven by a 12bps qoq decline in margins, reflecting the impact of a sharp decline in 1M HIBOR (300bps) and spot SORA (72bps) due to abundant liquidity amid a steady Fed Funds Rate. This margin compression was partially offset by improved market trading margins due to lower funding costs. We anticipate stable performance in other operating lines, with loan growth of +1% qoq/+4% yoy and fee income growth of +18% yoy, supported by improving investment sentiment in latter part of

2Q25, although tapering by -3% qoq from a high base in 1Q25. Operating expenses are expected to remain well-controlled at +3% qoq and +5% yoy. Despite heightened macro uncertainties, we expect stable asset quality and have incorporated a credit cost forecast of 20bps, at the higher end of the guidance range of 17-20bps.

- **OCBC:** We forecast 2Q25 net profit of S\$1,759mn (-7% qoq/-10% yoy). Similar to DBS, we anticipate that lower NIM will be the primary factor dragging down net profit. We expect NIM to decline by 12bps qoq, driven by the significant decrease in HIBOR and SORA rates. Furthermore, we project a qoq decrease in non-NII, due to lower fee income resulting from disruptions to investment sentiment in the wealth business following the Liberation Day, as well as a normalization of profits from the insurance business, leading to lower other non-NII. Our credit cost forecast is 25bps, a decrease from 26bps in 1Q25, but still at the higher end of the company's guidance of 20-25bps, as we incorporate a buffer for prevailing macro uncertainties.
- **UOB:** We forecast 2Q net profit of S\$1,425mn (-4% qoq/ -4% yoy), with lower revenue to be partly offset by lower credit cost. NII is expected to decline 5% qoq due to 10bps qoq decline in NIM, consistent with the trend of the other Singapore banks, while loan growth is expected to provide some cushion with growth of +1.2% qoq/ +5.4% yoy. Fee income and other non-NII are expected to weaken qoq, decreasing by 2.0% and 7.3% respectively, due to prevailing market conditions. Credit costs are forecasted at 30bps, lower than the 34bps in 1Q25 but at the higher end of the previous guidance of 25-30bps, reflecting our conservative approach. Operating expenses are expected to be well-controlled at -0% qoq and +7% yoy.

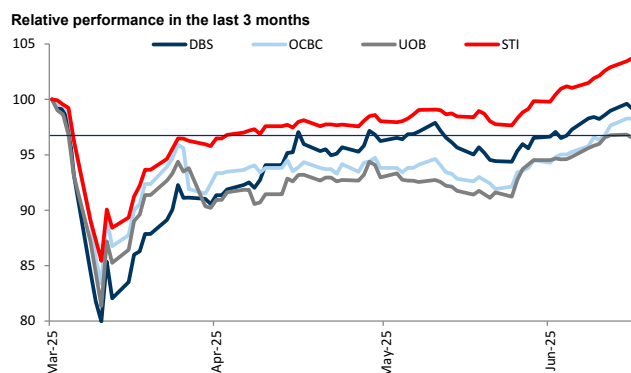
Exhibit 6: Singapore banks' results preview

S\$m	DBS					OCBC					UOB				
	2Q25E	1Q25	QoQ (%)	2Q24	YoY (%)	2Q25E	1Q25	QoQ (%)	2Q24	YoY (%)	2Q25E	1Q25	QoQ (%)	2Q24	YoY (%)
NII	3,519	3,681	(4.4)	3,594	(2.1)	2,239	2,345	(4.5)	2,430	(7.9)	2,298	2,409	(4.6)	2,401	(4.3)
Fee Income	1,234	1,275	(3.2)	1,048	17.8	522	546	(4.4)	466	12.0	680	694	(2.0)	618	10.0
Other Non-NII	896	949	(5.6)	840	6.7	697	764	(8.7)	733	(4.9)	514	554	(7.3)	457	12.4
Non- NII	2,130	2,224	(4.2)	1,888	12.8	1,219	1,310	(6.9)	1,199	1.7	1,194	1,248	(4.4)	1,075	11.0
Operating Expenses	(2,279)	(2,214)	2.9	(2,172)	4.9	(1,413)	(1,415)	(0.2)	(1,373)	2.9	(1,557)	(1,559)	(0.1)	(1,451)	7.3
PPOP	3,370	3,691	(8.7)	3,310	1.8	2,045	2,240	(8.7)	2,256	(9.3)	1,935	2,098	(7.8)	2,025	(4.5)
Impairment charges	(227)	(325)	(30.2)	(148)	53.3	(199)	(212)	(6.3)	(144)	37.9	(258)	(290)	(11.2)	(232)	11.0
Pre-tax Profit	3,218	3,437	(6.4)	3,213	0.2	2,098	2,297	(8.6)	2,332	(10.0)	1,722	1,822	(5.5)	1,718	0.2
Net Profit	2,727	2,897	(5.9)	2,733	(0.2)	1,759	1,883	(6.6)	1,944	(9.5)	1,425	1,490	(4.4)	1,410	1.1
Core Net Profit	2,727	2,897	(5.9)	2,752	(0.9)	1,759	1,883	(6.6)	1,944	(9.5)	1,425	1,490	(4.4)	1,488	(4.3)
Reported NIM (%)	2.00	2.12	-12bp	2.14	-14bp	1.92	2.04	-12bp	2.20	-28bp	1.90	2.00	-10bp	2.05	-15bp
Credit Costs (bps)	20	30	-9bp	14	7bp	25	26	-2bp	19	6bp	30	34	-4bp	29	1bp
Cost-to-income Ratio	40	37	3pp	40	1pp	41	39	2pp	38	3pp	45	43	2pp	42	3pp
Gross Loans	446,330	442,000	1.0	430,912	3.6	324,904	322,000	0.9	303,983	6.9	345,269	341,154	1.2	327,600	5.4
ROA (%)	1.29	1.39	-10bp	1.40	-11bp	1.10	1.19	-9bp	1.30	-20bp	1.02	1.10	-8bp	1.12	-10bp
ROE (%)	16.4	17.5	-105bp	17.7	-131bp	12.0	12.9	-91bp	14.1	-210bp	11.4	12.4	-96bp	12.9	-146bp

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

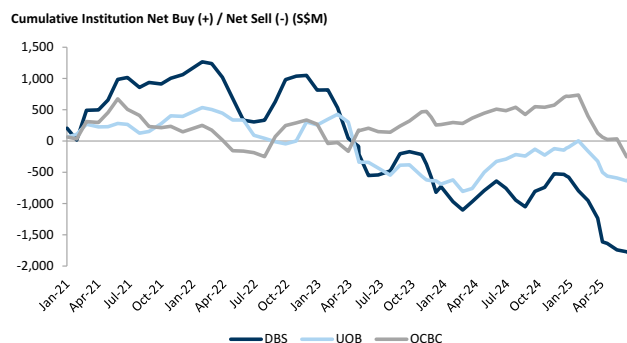
2Q25 in six charts

Exhibit 7: All three banks' share prices underperformed STI in 2Q25



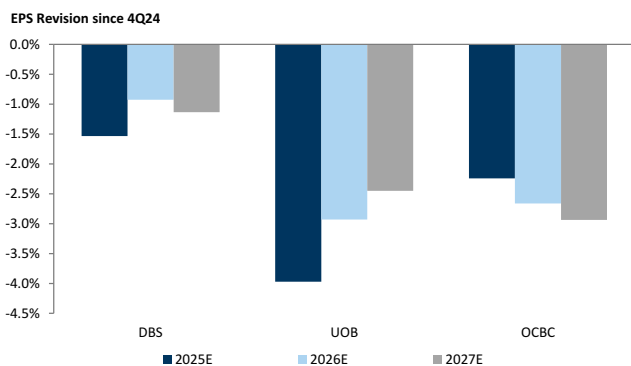
Source: Thomson Reuters, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: All three banks saw outflows from institutional investors in 2Q25



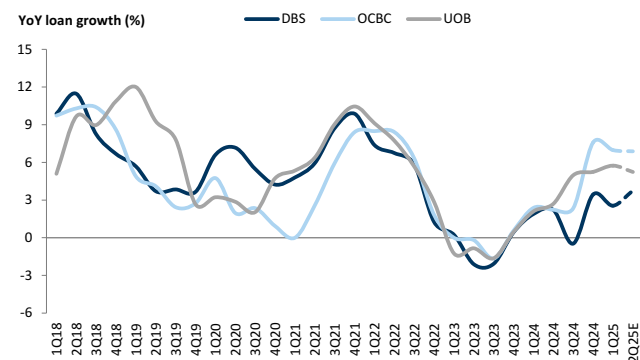
Source: SGX, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: Consensus EPS have been revised down for all three banks



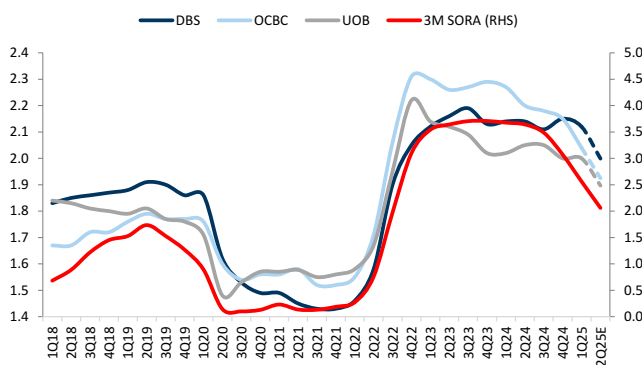
Source: Bloomberg

Exhibit 10: We anticipate credit growth to remain at mid to low single-digit levels for the Singapore banks in 2Q25, with OCBC showing the highest growth



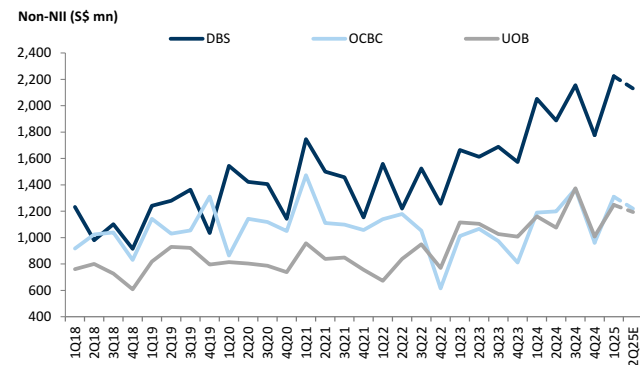
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: NIMs to trend lower in 2Q25 given the sharp declines in SORA and HIBOR



Source: MAS, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: We estimate non-NII to remain strong supported by wealth activity



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Revising estimates

For our Singapore banks coverage, we revise down 2025-27E EPS by 5-7%, mainly driven by lower NIMs as we discussed in the previous section. Our two-stage DDM valuation methodology is unchanged. Our target prices for the three banks have been adjusted downward by 1%, incorporating revised earnings forecasts and a lower cost of equity. The decreased cost of equity is due to lower risk free rate assumption based on our economists' forecast of a lower terminal rate, while our equity risk premium and beta assumptions are unchanged.

Exhibit 13: EPS changes

Company	New EPS estimates (\$)			Old EPS estimates			Earnings change		
	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E
DBS	3.67	3.86	4.08	3.86	4.07	4.32	-4.8%	-5.4%	-5.5%
OCBC	1.50	1.55	1.66	1.57	1.64	1.77	-4.8%	-5.9%	-6.0%
UOB	3.36	3.60	3.88	3.56	3.86	4.15	-5.7%	-6.6%	-6.5%
Singapore	2.84	3.00	3.21	3.00	3.19	3.41	-5.1%	-6.0%	-6.0%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

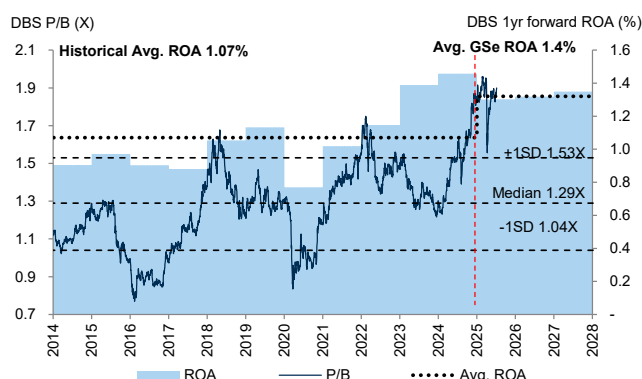
Exhibit 14: TP changes

Company name	Upside/downside to 12m TP	Total return	Current Price (Local Crncy) as of 18-Jul	12-m Target Price (Local Currency)			Rating	Key Risks
				New	Old	Change		
DBS	16%	22%	47.0	54.5	54.8	-1%	Buy	(-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanaged top management transition.
OCBC	13%	18%	17.3	19.6	19.7	-1%	Buy	(-) Sudden or sharper than expected FED cut cycle; (-) Changes in strategy to return capital; (-) Unexpected dilutive M&A activity.
UOB	21%	27%	37.0	44.7	45.3	-1%	Buy	(-) Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed rate cuts; (-) Poor execution of growth strategy in Citi franchise; (-) Unexpected deterioration in asset quality.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

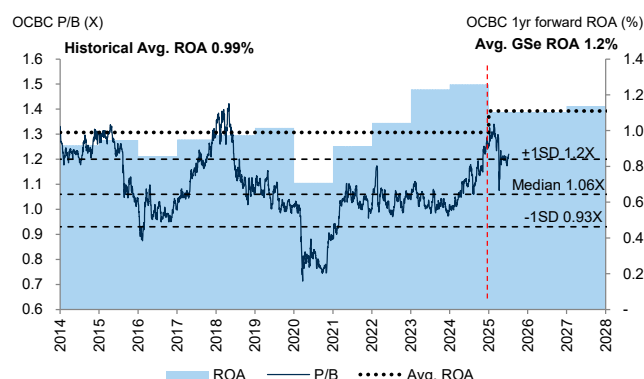
Valuation

Exhibit 15: DBS is trading at more than 1 std dev above its historical 10-year P/B median...



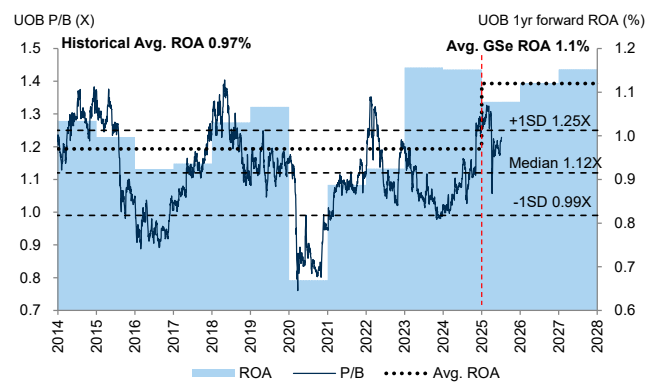
Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: ...while OCBC is trading close to 1 std dev above its historical 10-year P/B median...



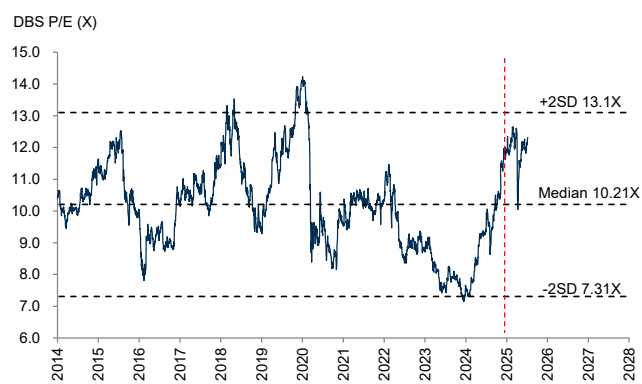
Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 17: ...and so is UOB



Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 18: On a P/E basis, DBS is trading more than 1 std dev above its historical 10-year median...



Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 19: ...while OCBC...



Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 20: ...and UOB are trading close to their historical 10-year median



Source: Datastream, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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Disclosures

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Goldman Sachs had an investment banking services client relationship during the past 12 months with: DBS Group (\$\$46.99), Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. (\$\$17.33) and United Overseas Bank (\$\$37.00)

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Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

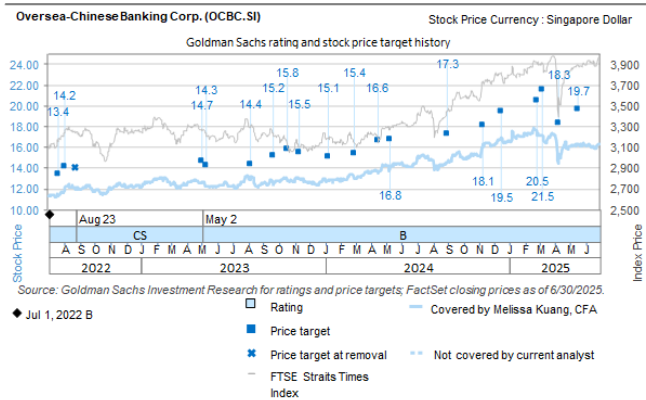
Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

	Rating Distribution			Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	49%	34%	17%	62%	57%	40%

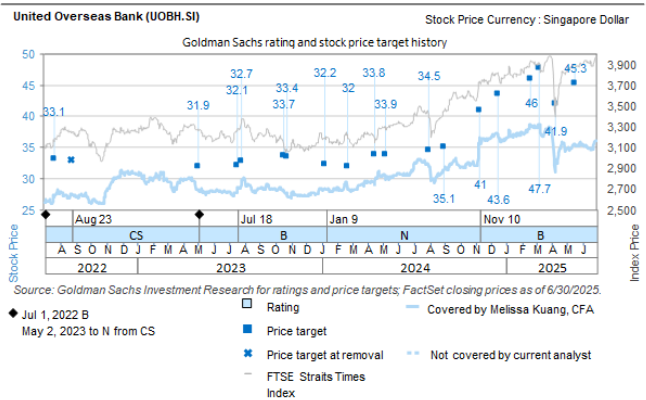
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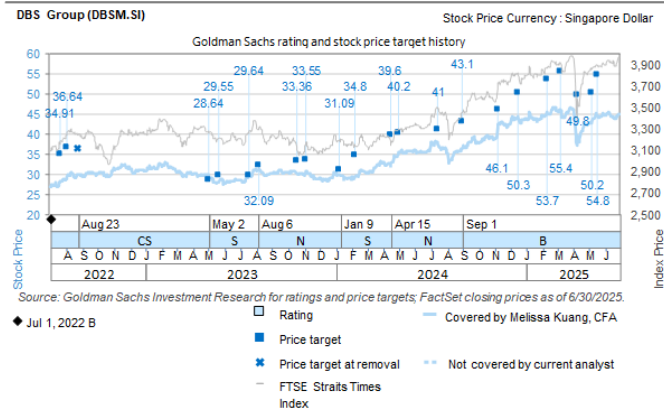
Price target and rating history chart(s)



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